



Government of **Western Australia**
School Curriculum and Standards Authority



ENGLISH

GENERAL COURSE

Externally set task

Sample 2016

Note: This Externally set task sample is based on the following content from Unit 3 of the General Year 12 syllabus.

- using strategies and skills for comprehending texts
- considering how perspectives and values are presented in texts
- developing and justifying own interpretations when responding to texts
- using appropriate vocabulary, spelling and sentence structures
- selecting text structures and language features to communicate and present ideas and information for different contexts and purposes

In future years, this information will be provided late in Term 3 of the year prior to the conduct of the Externally set task. This will enable teachers to tailor their teaching and learning program to ensure that the content is delivered prior to the students undertaking the task in Term 2 of Year 12.

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Any resources such as texts, websites and so on that may be referred to in this document are provided as examples of resources that teachers can use to support their learning programs. Their inclusion does not imply that they are mandatory or that they are the only resources relevant to the course.

English

Externally set task

Working time for the task: 60 minutes

Total marks: 40 marks

Weighting: 15% of the school mark

Refer to the passage below.

This extract is taken from *G Magazine*, May/June 2009.

More jobs on a green planet

Creating a sustainable future equals creating jobs says Greens Senator Christine Milne

Picture a carbon-neutral Australia. Picture an Australia where our homes and offices are mini power stations – using energy so efficiently that solar panels or small wind turbines on our roofs generate more power than we need.

Picture an Australia where those living on the land receive income from fields of solar collectors and wind turbines that, along with geothermal and wave power stations, power our vibrant economy cleanly, quietly and cleverly. The collectors provide shade for livestock and the carbon-rich soils are more fertile.

Picture an Australia where we can all travel to work, school and shops on convenient and efficient public transport, ride along safe cycleways or, when we need to, drive clean electric cars powered by those vast renewable sources of wind, wave and sun. That is, of course, when we aren't telecommuting via high speed broadband or eating food grown in our own gardens.

Picture an Australia where our forests are protected for the carbon they store as well as the biodiversity they nourish.

That is the Australia we need to build – and build fast – if we are to play our fair role in preventing climate catastrophe.

I don't know about you, but when I think of the scale of this transformation, what jumps to mind is that it's a huge job.

In fact, perhaps a million jobs or more! We will need every one who can to get involved in making this vision a reality.

When you grapple with this challenge, it becomes clear that the myth of climate change action costing jobs is either a deliberate fabrication¹ by those who don't want to change or a demonstration of complete lack of imagination. Quite the reverse is true. Right now, in fact, there is a strong push around the world for a 'green recovery plan', driven by grassroots organisations such as Green For All and Greens Parties, as well as from the very top – US President Obama and UN head Ban Ki-moon both promoting a global Green New Deal.

In the coming months, we will see hundreds of thousands of Australians and millions around the world – losing their jobs at a time when we need to put millions to work rebuilding for the carbon neutral economy.

We will need manufacturing workers to build wind turbines, solar collectors, buses and trains. We will need electricians, plumbers and builders. We will need natural resource managers and primary health carers. We will need town planners, architects, traders and lawyers. There are green jobs in every walk of life.

¹ fabrication: falsehood or a lie

Respond concisely, in short answer format of approximately 200–300 words for each question, on the answer sheets provided in this booklet.

1. Explain Senator Christine Milne’s perspective presented in her vision for a future Australia.

(20 marks)

[illegible]

2. How does Senator Milne influence her audience to respond to her perspective on Australia's future? (20 marks)

[illegible]

